



Helium makes WR 136 hot and bright. The star once burned using hydrogen, like our Sun. Hydrogen atoms smashed together in the star's core until they became helium atoms, releasing energy in the process. However, the star ran out of hydrogen about 200,000 years ago. It began smashing together helium atoms instead, and ballooned into a gigantic red star,

sending out a cloud of gas that spread around it. The star is producing a wind of electrified gases that hurtles out at 1,700 km (1,056 miles) every second. This wind continues to crash into the gas cloud, making it glow into the nebula we see. Eventually, WR 136 will run out of helium and its other fuels, and explode into an enormous fireball called a supernova.